

SUNDAY AFTER CHRISTMAS DAY.

BEHOLD a Virgin shall be with child, and shall bring forth a Son, and they shall call his name Emmanuel, which being interpreted is, God with us.

From the Gospel.



HEE, O Immanuel, we praise,
The Prince of Life, and Fount of Grace,
The Morning Star, the Heavenly
Flower,
The Virgin's Son, the Lord of Power !

With all Thy saints, Thee, Lord, we sing,
Praise, honour, thanks to Thee we bring,
That Thou, O long-expected guest,
Hast come at last to make us blest !

E'er since the world began to be,
How many a heart hath longed for Thee ;
Long years our fathers hoped of old
Their eyes might yet Thy Light behold.

The prophets cried : " Ah, would He came
To break the fetters of our shame ;
That help from Zion came to men,
Israel were glad, and prosper'd then ! "

Now art Thou here ; we know Thee now
In lowly manger liest Thou ;
A child, yet makest all things great,
Poor, yet is earth Thy robe of state.

All heavens are Thine, yet Thou dost come
To sojourn in a stranger's home ;
Thou hangest on Thy mother's breast
Who art the joy of spirits blest.

Now fearless I can look on Thee,
From sin and grief Thou sett'st me free ;
Thou bearest wrath, Thou conquerest Death,
Fear turns to joy Thy glance beneath.

Thou art my Head, my Lord Divine,
I am Thy member, wholly Thine,
And in Thy Spirit's strength would still
Serve Thee according to Thy will.

Thus will I sing Thy praises here
With joyful spirit year by year ;
And they shall sound before Thy throne,
Where time nor number more are known.

PAUL GERHARDT. 1650.

